

Pending Decisions and Open Questions

Kashmir bus route rationalisation → *Transport Policy* manuscript

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Every question in this document needs a person to answer it. Anything that could be settled from the code, the data or published sources already has been, and is recorded in Part D.

Part A is the meeting list: four questions for Avny ma'am and three for Prof. Kathuria. Part B is for the lead author, Part C lists what each co-author is asked to fix in their own section, and Part E is the remaining work in order.

Where things stand. Every analysis module has run and has been corrected after an independent audit; the methodology section is rewritten on the corrected results. The other sections still carry pre-correction numbers.

Word limit. Not assumed here. It follows Prof. Kathuria's answer to question K1.

Earlier versions of this document are in [paper/archive/](#).

How to use this document

Part A is the short list for the meeting with Avny ma'am and Prof. Kathuria: seven questions, nothing else. Part B is what the lead author still has to decide or supply. Part C is what each co-author is asked to fix in their own section. Part D lists what has been settled, so it is not reopened. Part E is the remaining work in order.

Part A — the bare minimum to ask in the meeting

Avny ma'am (4)

#	Question	Why it cannot be worked around
A1	What was actually done on the ground in Srinagar, and which word may the paper use: adopted, approved, or reviewed?	Decides how the whole paper is framed. Claiming implementation without a record would be the most damaging overclaim possible.
A2	The 1-12 August field observations: who did them, in which year, and can we have the raw sheets?	They become a real validation channel in §6. Without the sheets they stay as her narrative.
A3	Is she comfortable being listed with her post, with a line saying the department supplied the data and reviewed the plan? Does publishing need clearance? May the paper say the headway rules were set in review with the regulator?	Competing-interest statement and §4. The journal requires the first; the audit requires the second.
A4	In the e-bus data, does "Trip Count" mean one-way trips or round trips?	One validation result reverses depending on the answer (ratio 1.29-1.58 or 0.64-0.79). Only the operator knows.

One thing to show her, not ask: the register gives every permit an expiry date, and 678 of the 679 valid bus permits are five-year permits. Her draft says permits have "no end validity". Suggested wording: "five-year permits, renewed as a matter of course".

Prof. Kathuria (3)

#	Question	Why
K1	Word limit. His brief says 9,000-10,000. The draft is about 13,800. What do we plan for?	Decides how much goes to a supplement. Our earlier reading of the journal guide (8,000) could not be re-checked and is not being assumed.
K2	Can IIT Jammu's ethics committee review or exempt the driver-GPS collection?	Drivers were asked by the regulator to install the app and started each recording themselves; the research-consent screen was added later. The journal asks for an ethics statement.
K3	Confirm the Srinagar-only numbers in his template (342 permits, 207 routes, 1,009 buses, "Srinagar Metropolitan Region") are placeholders, and the paper reports the ten-district plan (614 permits, 157 corridors, 186 routes, 1,011 buses) with Srinagar as the place it was checked on the ground.	§1, §3 and §7 are still written to the template's scope.

Part B — lead author (Prashant)

To decide

#	Decision	Recommendation
B1	Merge Sharvesh's pull request on GitHub	Merge. It is already in the working branch.
B2	Which service day the paper uses for time-of-day results: 11 h (timetables), 16 h or 17 h (observed)	11 h, to match the timetables; state the others. The bus-hour saving is 2.9-5.7 % on 11 h and 7.3-9.4 % on 17 h.

#	Decision	Recommendation
B3	One fleet recommendation: 1,011 as specified, or the observed-pace range (median 1,182; 1,130–1,266)	State 1,011 as the plan and the range as what it would take at observed speeds; do not call 1,011 a floor.
B4	Trim \$4 from about 3,000 words now or after K1	After K1.
B5	Three author-placed village coordinates that still look wrong (Shanglipora lands in Srinagar city; Loolpora is 42 km from the engine's point; Zaloora is farther from Srinagar than its route is long)	Re-check with someone local before the public release. Affects the public gazetteer only.
B6	Arizal: the open-source point is 13.9 km from the engine's point	Same.
B7	Four admin e-mail addresses are visible in the dashboard's login code	Move them out of client code.
B8	LinkedIn carousel	Hold until rewritten on the corrected numbers.
B9	Add the place name to the title as a subtitle	Ask Prof. Kathuria only if he raises the title.

To supply

#	Item
B10	Who did what, in a few sentences, for the author-contribution statement (app, backend, engine, analysis, dashboard, data, fieldwork, writing, supervision).
B11	Whether co-authors used AI tools for their own sections. Screening and coding in §2 already declare Claude.
B12	Whether any of the 49 AI-researched route distances were checked by a person, and how many.
B13	Author order, corresponding author, institution for each of the six authors.
B14	Funding statement, or "none".
B15	From Krishna: does the app record who accepted or declined the consent pop-up? If yes, decliners can be dropped from the dataset.
B16	Who "Karroh" (logo on the app screen) is, for the acknowledgements.
B17	Restrict the two Firebase keys in the console.

Part C — corrections each co-author is asked to make

Section	Authors	What to fix
§1 Introduction	Misti, Avny	"644 legacy permits into 186 corridors" → 614 permits, 157 corridors, 186 routes. Section numbers in the roadmap. Add a reference for the report cited as "CSE & CITIES Forum (2026)" (title: <i>Reinventing the Urban Bus</i>); the 0.44 benchmark is that report's own figure, not the ministry's. "MoHUA (2014)" → the ministry's 2009 Service Level Benchmarks. Metro and BRT cost per km: replace the Badami & Haider attribution (a 2010 ministry presentation gives US\$45 M and US\$2.4 M per km); drop "under US\$0.05 M per km" (no source exists). "Fewer than 15 GTFS agencies" (about 17 publish one). "Nine Jhelum bridges" and "2.5 million tourists" need a source or rewording. "Validated against 43,809 GPS runs" → 2,526 runs, and not "validated". Permits "in perpetuity". Grammar and spelling pass.
§2 Literature	Sharvesh, Ankit	One sentence in §2.8 ("no ... ticketing ... data at any stage") is too strong: e-bus aggregates enter at five points (§4.5). Trim towards the length agreed under K1.
§3 Study area	Krishna	GPS corpus is 2,526 runs. Ethics paragraph (after K2). Scope wording (after K3). Dataset names: WorldPop R2025A constrained; OpenStreetMap northern-India extract of 6 January 2026.
§6 Validation	Avny, Krishna	Merge the field-observation text once the raw sheets are available (A2). The Lalbazar-LD row shows 10 buses in an hour but a frequency of 5.
§7 Discussion	Ankit, Avny, Misti	"No statutory change needed" sits beside instruments that need one. Mention PM-eBus Sewa (100 e-buses allocated to Srinagar). "No service obligation" against the permit conditions described in §1.
Figure 1 and 3	Misti, Krishna	Text describes a two-panel and a four-panel figure; both are drawn as single panels. Redraw, or change the description.

Part D — settled (do not reopen)

Item	Outcome
Literature protocol	Run by Sharvesh: 5,488 records, 60 studies coded, gap figure, 37 references added.
Fleet today	777 = 679 private buses with a valid permit (March 2026) + 98 e-buses. Plan is +30 %. JKRTC stays in the plan and out of the baseline, and the paper says so.
GPS corpus	2,526 runs. The 43,809 figure counted each run once per route it touched.
Demand-sized fleet	Added: 551 buses at a 70 % load target with no minimum service; 508 of the 1,011 are explained by demand, 503 by the service standards.
Title	As set by Prof. Kathuria.
Structure and section authors	As in the co-author brief.
Regulator	Not named as RTOs; "the transport regulator".
Consent wording	Drivers were asked by the regulator to install the app and started each recording themselves; the consent screen was added later. Stated as such.
AI tools	Claude throughout; limited early use of Gemini and Codex, declared in one clause.
Vehicle classes	The register's heavy, medium and light classes; not "priority" classes.
Datasets	WorldPop R2025A v1 constrained; Geofabrik northern-India extract, 6 January 2026.
ArcGIS coordinates	18 of 26 replaced from open sources, 7 author-placed, 1 not a place. Plan unchanged. No engine re-run.
Engine re-run	Not done; the published plan stands and its provenance is disclosed in §4.2.
Older repositories	Made private. Dashboard claims reworded and personal data removed (live).
Public repository	To be rebuilt as one clean release at the end.
Audit reports	Kept local, not in git.
Validation as it stands	Building-footprint check passes but is partly circular and its layer was changed after the first failed; e-bus benchmark fails; expert panel not conducted; GPS confirms route geometry but fails on travel time. Reported as such.

Part E — remaining work, in order

- 1 Update the claim ledger and rewrite §5, §6, §8, abstract and highlights on the corrected numbers (§4 is done; draft PDF issued).
- 2 Document build: full reference list, embedded tables including Table 3 and Table 7, figure numbering.
- 3 Corrections sheet to co-authors (Part C).
- 4 Cut to the agreed length; supplement.
- 5 Front matter: contribution statement, competing interests, AI declaration, ethics, data availability.
- 6 Rebuild the public repository; correct licences (Microsoft footprints are CDLA-Permissive-2.0).
- 7 Final re-check of numbers, figures and consistency across paper, repository and dashboard; then submit.